

Strategy for visiting New Zealand to explore job opportunities

Visiting New Zealand on a tourist visa can be a fantastic opportunity to explore the local job market and assess whether the country is the right fit for you. With stunning landscapes, a high quality of life, and a growing economy, New Zealand offers a wealth of professional opportunities. However, to maximise your chances of success, it's essential to have a well-thought-out plan.

We've created this document to outline a comprehensive strategy to help you make the most of your visit and increase your chances of securing employment.

Pre-arrival preparation: Travel arrangements

Our relocation expert, Paul Arthur, is here to help you get your trip off to a smooth start. From travel to settling in, Paul can assist you with:

- **Flights:** Find the best deals and ensure your flight schedule aligns with your job-hunting plans.
- **Accommodation:** We can help you secure temporary housing or provide advice on long-term rental options, depending on your needs.
- **Car hire:** For exploring New Zealand's diverse regions or attending interviews, we can arrange reliable car hire options.
- **Travel insurance:** Ensure that you're covered in case of emergencies, especially with healthcare costs and unforeseen disruptions.
- **Sim cards:** Stay connected easily by arranging a local SIM card with a suitable plan.

For more information and assistance with any of these services, please contact Paul directly at paul.arthur@workingin.com.

Meet New Zealand's visitor requirements

To avoid any delays or issues at the border, ensure you meet New Zealand's visitor visa requirements:

- 1. Genuine visitor intent:** Be clear about your purpose for visiting—combine leisure with job exploration to show your intent to experience New Zealand while also seeking potential work opportunities.
- 2. Proof of funds:**
 - NZ\$1000 per month if accommodation isn't pre-arranged.
 - NZ\$450 per month if you've already booked your accommodation.
- 3. Return ticket:** You will need to provide proof of a return ticket to demonstrate your commitment to leaving New Zealand at the end of your visitor visa term.



Networking and connecting before you arrive

Your job search should begin even before you set foot in New Zealand. Networking and making connections ahead of time can give you a head start and help you better understand the job market:

- **Research the job market:** Familiarise yourself with the industries, companies, and roles that align with your skills. Understand the demand for your profession in New Zealand.
- **Connect on LinkedIn:** Reach out to recruiters, potential employers, and industry professionals in your field. Let them know about your upcoming visit and express your interest in job opportunities. LinkedIn is a powerful tool for making connections before you arrive.
- **Join industry groups:** Engage with professional associations or LinkedIn groups related to your industry to stay informed about trends and events.
- **Look for networking opportunities:** New Zealand hosts numerous professional events, job fairs, and industry meetups. Try to identify these events in advance and plan to attend them. Participating in these activities can be invaluable for meeting key people in your field.
- **Schedule interviews:** If possible, try to secure at least one interview before you arrive. This will help you hit the ground running and make the most of your visit.

Be prepared

The more prepared you are before your arrival, the more successful your job search will be:

- **Tailor your CV:** Ensure your CV is up to date and highlights relevant experience and skills that align with the roles you are targeting. You can find advice on creating a CV adapted to the New Zealand job market as well as an easy to follow template on our MyMove portal.
- **Have digital copies of important documents:** Make sure you have digital copies of your CV, qualifications, certifications, and reference letters. Having these documents easily accessible will allow you to respond quickly to job opportunities.
- **Understand salary expectations and workplace culture:** Research salary ranges in your field to understand what to expect in terms of compensation. Familiarise yourself with the New Zealand workplace culture, which may differ from what you're used to.
- **Be transparent about your status:** While you're on a tourist visa, be upfront with potential employers about your visitor status and explain that you plan to transition to a work visa if a suitable job offer is made.
- **Download your support letter from Working In New Zealand:** Carry a digital copy of our support letter which you can download via our MyMove portal. This can strengthen your case with potential employers and demonstrate that you have the guidance and expertise needed to navigate the visa process.

Additional tips

- **Stay flexible:** Job markets can be unpredictable, so be open to opportunities in various locations and industries.
- **Follow up on leads:** After attending interviews or networking events, make sure to follow up with a thank-you email or message. This will keep you top of mind for potential employers.
- **Enjoy the experience:** Remember to balance your job search with enjoying your time in New Zealand. The more relaxed and positive you are, the more likely you are to make a good impression.

By planning ahead and following these steps, you'll maximise your chances of securing a job while exploring New Zealand's beautiful landscapes. The combination of thorough preparation, proactive networking, and understanding the local job market will give you a distinct advantage.

If you'd like more details on any points outlined here feel free to get in touch with us, or if you're planning a trip to Auckland we'd love to meet you in person—speak with one of our team and arrange a time to visit us. We're here to help you every step of the way!

